



STATUS REPORT

Gabon — digital transformation and data governance status report

Edition of 2026-08-18 · compiled from the Data Landscapers source base

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Coverage has stopped being Gabon's binding constraint. Some 98% of the population had at least a 4G signal in 2022, the regulator put mobile broadband at about 97% of national territory in 2024, with over two million internet and mobile subscribers, and there are now around 124 mobile connections per 100 people (2025), 88.9% of them capable of 3G or better (November 2025). Set against that, about 71.9% of the population used the internet in 2023, and territorial coverage is not the same as usable service: rural primary clinics were still keeping patient records on paper in 2022, held there by unreliable connectivity and a shortage of computers. Access also runs on terms the state sets, and the suspension of social media was still in force in July 2026.

The decade-long trend is one of the strongest on the continent. Gabon's Internet and Computers score rose 23.3 points over 2014-2023 to 48.5 of 100, 14th of 54 African states and the third most improved of its 96 governance indicators, mobile communications stood at 74.2, 17th of 54, and the country scored 76.1 on the ITU's ICT Development Index in 2024, 11th in Africa. Infrastructure is the best-ranked sub-category in a parent category that ranks 42nd, at 46.6 of 100 and 18th of 54. What the public makes of it points the other way: public perception of infrastructure is one of Gabon's ten worst indicators at 12.2 of 100 in 2023, having fallen 17.9 points over the decade.

The remaining gap is physical. Fibre cannot reach everywhere in a country with 88% forest cover, which is the case a national policy process on satellite communications opened in July 2026 is built on. Domestic traffic exchange remains thin: GABIX, the national internet exchange point, has a membership of around six or seven (2025), and its development is still a named priority of the digital economy ministry (July 2026). The sector operates under Law No. 026/2018, with the backbone built under a regional programme that closed in 2020 and the World Bank's Digital Gabon operation running to 2028.

Data Storage

Gabon's first Tier III certified data centre opened on 3 July 2026 in the Nkok special economic zone near Libreville, inaugurated by President Brice Oligui Nguema. It was built by the Cameroonian operator ST Digital on a roughly 3,000 square metre site, with capacity for around 3,000 physical servers across cloud, colocation and private suite halls, and an entirely Gabonese technical staff — the sovereign facility is thus the work of a foreign builder run by

Gabonese engineers. It commissions 92 racks with 1 MW of IT power and is peered to the ACE and SAT-3/WACS submarine systems, at a cost of about 8 billion CFA francs, some US\$14 million (July 2026), eleven months after ground was broken in August 2025.

The state has made domestic hosting the explicit basis of its digital sovereignty policy, presenting the launch as the end of the country's reliance on foreign digital infrastructure, the dependence on servers abroad it is meant to close. The data protection authority was a real gate rather than a formality: the APDPVP accompanied the project for months to verify compliance before commissioning, and ST Digital credited it with securing the authorisations the launch required.

The binding rules are older than the building. Law No. 027/2023 requires electronic communications operators to run an operational infrastructure and data management centre on national territory (Article 22), to host confidential or sensitive data exclusively in Gabon absent a written exemption (Article 27), and to keep a domestic copy of their data (Article 36). Government's own hosting is the weaker half. Gabon has no shared cloud platform available across government entities, and no platform type or cloud service is recorded for it (2025), with nothing published on where government data may be held or on government cloud usage, even though the World Bank's eGabon operation has financed a government data centre since 2016. Nor does the new capacity change the hyperscaler picture: Gabon has no direct cloud on-ramp for AWS, Azure or Google Cloud, so enterprises reach those services over interconnects to Lagos or Cape Town at latencies above 100 milliseconds (September 2025).

Energy

Gabon has close to universal electricity access and a supply that does not hold. Frequent outages and regular load shedding in the capital drew public anger in 2025, in a country where 94.1% of the population had access to electricity in 2023 and access to energy is one of its ten best-scoring governance indicators at 91.2 of 100, 7th of 54 African states. Access measured that way says nothing about whether the power stays on, which is the property a data centre or a government system depends on.

The national average also conceals the geography. Electricity reached 99.2% of the urban population in 2023 but only 29.0% of the rural population, a gap of some seventy percentage points that tracks the concentration of grid supply in Libreville and the other towns — and therefore sets the outer limit on where any digital service that needs mains power can operate. For those on the grid, residential electricity cost about US\$0.214 per kilowatt hour in December 2025, so a benchmark 100 kWh month absorbs roughly 3% of income per head.

Technical Capacity

Gabon has the institutional furniture of a digital state and publishes none of its results. The GovTech Maturity Index records a ministry leading public sector digital transformation and a cross-government forum at which senior digital officials address digital, data, technology and capacity questions across the state, with progress against the transformation programme reported internally and not published (2025), alongside an established GovTech entity, a coordination body leading GovTech initiatives and an entity monitoring digital spending across government — whose annual progress report is likewise internal. Gabon scores better on those institutional measures than on almost anything else the index asks of it.

The administration underneath them is a weak point. Public Administration is Gabon's second worst-ranked governance sub-category, at 38.4 of 100 in 2023 and 45th of 54 African states, despite improving 3.0 points over the decade, and effective administration scored 46.7, 33rd of 54, essentially flat across 2014-2023. Delivery runs through ANINF, the technical body for the World-Bank-financed eGabon and Gabon Digital projects, which opened its first office outside Libreville, in Franceville, in June 2026. The operating disciplines are thinner than the institutions: no data quality framework for government information systems, no uptime monitoring, no guidance for replacing legacy systems, and nothing published on interoperability compliance.

The pipeline exists and is largely untested in public. The Université Numérique du Gabon, a public distance-learning institution, offers licence and master's degrees in computer science, cybersecurity, big data, artificial intelligence, DevOps and data engineering (2025). Where systems are running, capability is shared with suppliers — the electronic identity card system is run by the interior ministry with technical support from the French supplier IN Groupe (2024) — and external money is going into the state's own skills: the US State Department is funding about US\$1 million of cybersecurity capacity-building with ANINF across 2024-2025, aimed at national frameworks, incident response and digital resilience.

Cybersecurity

Gabon has built the law well ahead of the machine. It scored 39.85 of 100 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index in 2024, up from 11.38 in the 2020 edition, with full marks on legal measures and weak technical, organisational and cooperation measures — a rise that still leaves it in Tier 4 of the index's five tiers. The operational side is where the gap shows: a dedicated security operations centre for government systems was still planned rather than running as of December 2024. The legal half rests on the 2023 cybersecurity and cybercrime law and on a data protection regime under which controllers must notify the authority without delay and tell affected individuals where a breach poses a high risk to their rights, with public administrations separately required to report incidents as soon as they become aware of them.

What has been built since is instrumentation rather than defence. ANINF launched SecBOM in June 2025, a tool to map, control and protect the state's sensitive digital assets, an initiative driven from the Presidency and framed, like the rest of the national cyber effort, as digital sovereignty. The agency is working with the US-based MITRE Corporation on the design of Gabon's cybersecurity architecture (June 2026), an American technical thread in a country whose digital partnerships have not usually run that way.

Enforcement and assurance come mostly from outside. Gabon took part in Interpol's Serengeti 2.0 cybercrime operation alongside seventeen other African countries with UK backing (August 2025), and the Banque de France carried out a bilateral IT and cybersecurity audit at BEAC, the central bank serving Gabon, in October 2025. Domestically, the field is convening: the second national Cybersecurity Forum, on protecting critical infrastructure, was held in November 2025 with ANINF alongside the Gabonese firms ST Digital, CN Consulting and BGFI Services.

DPI

Data Exchange

No government body was exchanging data on Gabon's planned interoperability platform as of June 2024, against a target of five by 2026, and [the platform itself had not been deployed](#). The framework meant to govern that exchange was unpublished on the same date, with adoption targeted for June 2026, and the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index recorded [no government interoperability framework of any kind in 2025](#). A [2025 ordinance requires public administrations to digitise their services and interconnect their systems](#), but the machinery beneath it is thin: Gabon has [no dedicated body for data governance and no data governance strategy](#), and [no data quality framework for government information systems, no monitoring of their uptime and nothing published on interoperability compliance \(2025\)](#).

What does flow, flows point to point. Business registration data moves automatically from [the investment agency's one-stop platform to the tax administration, the court registry and the two social funds](#). The social insurance and pension system, by contrast, [exchanges data with no other government system \(2025\)](#). Coordination has existed since February 2021, when an inter-ministerial committee was created under the Prime Minister's office with [ANINF as coordinator, with no regional or local government body exchanging data on any platform \(2024\)](#).

The identity layer is separated by design. A legal covenant of the World Bank-financed identity programme requires [the biometric population registry, the civil register and the identity card database to remain functionally separate](#), and as of mid-2025 the institutions were [still building the joint technical and legal roadmap to interconnect them, so a birth does not yet generate a personal identification number](#).

Digital Identity and CRVS

Two years after Gabon [issued its first electronic national identity card in June 2024](#), the interior minister told the National Assembly on 2 June 2026 that [335,384 people had enrolled, 164,944 cards had been produced and 147,224 collected](#), with 92,614 files still in processing and 78,500 classed as disputed.

Fewer than half of those enrolled hold a card: collections come to about 44% of enrolments (June 2026). Disputed files amount to roughly 23% of everything enrolled to June 2026, which makes data quality a structural feature of the build rather than an administrative backlog.

The card [ended an eleven-year gap in national identity card issuance](#) and rests on a 14-digit personal identification number whose enrolment [Law 027/2020 makes compulsory for every person present on Gabonese territory, citizens and non-nationals alike](#). Registration and the attestation are free, as is the first card; [enrolment opens at 16](#); the attestation is [the prerequisite for applying for the card, which is accepted, though not required, for banking](#). Behind it sits [IBOGA, the biometric master database running since 2012 with automated deduplication](#); the Interior Ministry's documentation and immigration directorate runs the card [with technical support from the French supplier IN Groupe \(2024\)](#).

The World Bank results indicator for the share of Gabonese aged 16 and over holding a NIP [stood at zero in December 2024 against a target of 90% by June 2026](#), and health insurance beneficiary records tied to a NIP [stood at zero against a target of 250,000](#); most social insurance records remain [keyed on the schemes' own identifiers](#)

rather than the national number (2025). The electoral roll is the exception: an online service returns a citizen's registration and polling centre against their NIP (2025). Three projects launched on 23 June 2025 — extending the biometric population register, a national digital identity system and a national civil registration centre — are the layer beneath the card, whose biometric processing is lawful only through a derogation from the 2023 data protection statute. Public perception of how easy it is to obtain an identity document stood at 29.1 of 100 in 2023, 28th of 54 African states.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Gabonese bank cards are used to get cash rather than to pay: of 1,101,434 card transactions in June 2026, 62.41% were ATM withdrawals and 24.61% payments at merchant terminals. The estate behind that was 326 ATMs and 1,535 merchant terminals at end-June 2026, serving 457,377 cardholders among 673,793 bank clients, of whose cards 440,869 carry an international scheme and only 16,508 are domestic private-label.

The merchant terminal estate is nearly five times the size of the ATM estate yet carries under half the ATM network's transaction traffic (June 2026).

Mobile money is the wider channel, with Global Findex putting digital payment use among Gabonese adults at 66.5% and mobile money account ownership at 61.6% in 2024. The rail is regional rather than national: Gabon's digital payments build sits on the CEMAC GIMACPAY system operated through GIMAC and the central bank, live since July 2020 and connecting more than 91 direct and indirect participants including banks, mobile money operators, microfinance institutions, the treasury and the post office, and treating cross-border transfers within the monetary union on the same basis as domestic ones. BEAC owns 99.2% of GIMAC, chairs its management committee and acts as settlement agent (2023), so the central bank operates the payment system rather than only overseeing it. Its scheme rules are not public, and it has established no effective consumer recourse, its governance including no body representing consumers or low-income users (2023).

State payments moved on to that rail in December 2025 with MADIGIPAIE, which lets citizens pay the state by mobile money using QR codes; more than 1,000 interoperable QR codes had reached merchants by December 2025, the scheme reached the TaxiGab transport network on 28 February 2026 and Libreville's municipality committed to supporting its deployment in July 2026. On the revenue side the tax directorate reports at least 80% of tax revenue collected through its Digitax remote-payment platform (2024), with electronic filing and payment mandatory for medium and large enterprises since April 2024. Regional reporting is annual, through BEAC's report on payment services in CEMAC, the latest edition covering 2024.

Registries

No administrative department in Gabon had a civil registration office registering vital acts digitally as of December 2024, against a project target of fifteen by June 2026. Registration remains paper-based and decentralised at the point of registration (2023), and Law 008/2022, which provides for a centralised digital and biometric civil register run by a new national civil registration centre, has not been implemented; the same law extends registration obligations to foreign nationals residing in or passing through the country. Gabon's civil registration score in the Ibrahim Index rose 12.5 points over 2014-2023 to 37.5 of 100, still 47th of 54 African states.

The registers that function are electoral and commercial. The biometric population registry was seeded with roughly 690,000 records migrated from the IBOGA voter file in a one-off transfer, about half the adult population (2021); the electoral register held 846,822 voters before the August 2023 elections, 16,093 of them registered abroad; and the 2025 electoral code makes the roll a permanent national biometric file built from the national biometric register, registering anyone already holding a personal identification number automatically on turning 18. Company registration runs online through ANPI-Gabon's investment window, which handles registration, payment and issue of the single registration record, while dematerialisation of the RCCM commercial register at the Ministry of Justice is still in progress (2025), with the RCCM number and the taxpayer number issued within about 48 hours of each other.

Land and social registers are the weakest. Formal titling covers a very small share of land, the cadastre operating in practice only in urban areas (2012), and the housing ministry engaged the French firm IGN FI in 2025 to modernise it. The unified social registry was still being built as of mid-2026, with implementation expected to run through 2027; on the government's own diagnosis the existing register of economically weak citizens is not reliable enough to target social protection, and a second census begins in September 2026. There is also no national standardised address register, so neither the land register nor the business register can be tied to an address database (2026).

Sectoral management information systems

Gabon's core financial systems exist but stop short of what they are usually built for: the integrated financial management information system is in use and custom-built, but its functional coverage is limited to treasury execution and its scope to central government (2025). The tax management system is custom software and exchanges data with other government systems, the customs system is off-the-shelf, also exchanges data, and customs and tax administrations are kept separate, and a debt management system is in use while there is no public investment management system at all. SIGFIP, an integrated public finance platform launched in January 2026, consolidates state payments and revenues behind a single interface connected to the Treasury, banks and electronic payment operators. On the personnel side there is no human resources management information system for the public service, no employee or manager self-service portal, and public-service HR records are not linked to the national identity number (2025), and the social insurance and pension system exchanges data with nothing else.

Health is the most built-out sector. DHIS2 was launched nationally in December 2024, but it sits at the aggregation and reporting level, with data managers transcribing paper register entries into the platform rather than capturing them digitally at the point of care; a national assessment of 71 facilities found only 45% possessed any digital tool for collecting and storing data (2022), and rural clinics record patients on paper, compelled to by unreliable connectivity and limited access to computers. The eGabon hospital information system reached two pilot hospitals from December 2023 with provisional handover in December 2024, and a second phase launched in 2025 extends it to eight more; health is also the one sector with its own interoperability framework, the CI-SIS. Education has been distributing tablets and data-collection software to schools since March 2025 to strengthen its education management information system, while police stations and gendarmerie brigades keep criminal cases, complaints and custody records on paper (February 2026). Tax and revenue mobilisation is among Gabon's ten most deteriorated Ibrahim Index indicators, down 17.5 points over 2014-2023 to 30.8 of 100 and 46th of 54.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Gabon posted the leading e-government score in Middle Africa in 2024, 0.5741, ranking 121st of 193 states, without having a national service portal at all: there is no one-stop shop, no government mobile application, no way for a resident to start a business online and no published performance data on online service delivery (2025). What works is sectoral. The tax portal is in use and offers taxpayer registration and filing, the social insurance and pension portal handles registration, benefits and payments, a government job portal offers registration and job search, and the Interior Ministry runs an online check of electoral registration and polling station by personal identification number (2025). Businesses selling to the state get less: there is no e-procurement portal, so tendering and contract award are not conducted online.

The newest service is a free three-month tourist e-Visa announced by the head of state and delivered through a single platform developed in 2025 and operated by the immigration directorate, whose familiarisation sessions were run for tour operators, guides, travel agencies, hotels and restaurants, the last in Libreville on 31 July 2026 rather than for travellers; no start or end date for the window, no application volumes and no platform address have been published. Where an online channel fails, nobody answers for it: as of August 2026 no agency had been named as owning the rejections coming out of the online NIP channel, and no rejection figures, queue depth or resolution route had been published.

Institutionally the picture is stronger than the service estate suggests. Gabon has a government entity focused on GovTech, a coordination body leading GovTech initiatives and an entity monitoring digital spending across government, though the institution's annual progress report is internal and unpublished (2025); ANINF is the technical delivery body for the World Bank-financed eGabon and Gabon Digital projects, under which SIGFIP, DigiTax, e-invoicing and the e-visa platform all sit rather than under separate ministry initiatives, and an ordinance published in September 2025 gave e-government its first comprehensive legal basis. The single window itself, Gabon Connect, was presented to President Oligui Nguema in February 2026.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The provision that makes Gabon's national biometric identity card lawful points at the wrong article. Article 75 of loi n°025/2023 of 12 July 2023 prohibits outright the collection or processing of biometric and genetic data, alongside racial and ethnic origin, political, philosophical and religious opinion, union membership, health and sexual life, and article 76 is the only way out of it — but the derogation article 76 grants is written against "l'interdiction prévue par l'article 74", which governs children's data. Nothing on the statute book has corrected it. The same law binds controllers from its publication on 15 July 2023, with no transition period, so every system already running when it appeared was in scope on day one; it amends the 2011 statute that first created the regime and is the instrument now governing personal data.

The rest of the digital statute book is more conventional. Electronic communications run under Law No. 026/2018; a dedicated law covers electronic transactions, taking in electronic signature, digital identification and digital payments; and the 2023 cybersecurity and cybercrime law imposes data localisation on electronic communications operators. Identity and civil status are legislated ahead of delivery: enrolment for the personal identification number

is compulsory for every person present on Gabonese territory, the 2025 electoral code builds the roll from the national biometric register, and Law 008/2022 provides for a centralised biometric civil registry that has not been implemented.

Two recent instruments matter most. An ordinance published in the Journal Officiel of 7 September 2025 gives e-government its first comprehensive legal basis, requiring public administrations to digitise services, interconnect systems and bring in the private sector. An ordonnance of 8 April 2026 regulates digital platforms, and civil society is asking for provisions of it to be revised as disproportionate. The largest hole is older: Gabon has no right-to-information law, and none in draft.

Strategies, plans and policies

Gabon's 2026 digital allocation is 82bn CFA francs, 156.2% above the 2025 figure — a decision taken while disbursement on the World Bank-financed eGabon and Gabon Digital programmes was running far behind schedule, with the same ministers noting the foundations were in place but execution too slow.

The commitments themselves are thinner than the money implies. Gabon has a current national digital transformation strategy, but a whole-of-government approach to public sector digital transformation only planned or in draft. There is a ministry leading the work and a cross-government forum at which senior digital officials meet, though progress against the transformation programme is reported internally and not published. And there is no government entity responsible for data governance, no data governance strategy or policy, and nothing published on how government data is governed — an absence sitting directly beneath a programme whose stated purpose is interconnecting state systems.

Delivery is steered rather than owned. A comité de pilotage held its fifth session in February 2026, and a World Bank mission met ANINF in June 2026 to review the closure of the e-Gabon project and the execution of Gabon Digital. Instructions arrive as one-off directives: one of 3 October 2025 requires the public financial agencies to be digitised. The framing throughout is sovereignty — the SecBOM cybersecurity initiative is driven from the Presidency and combines technical, legal-compliance and sovereigntist objectives, and the digital economy minister presents the e-government ordinance as a reform for service access, administrative transparency and digital sovereignty. The ministry's next-phase priorities, set on 31 July 2026, are governance of digital projects, the GabIX exchange point, infrastructure, an institutional content strategy and digital diplomacy.

The administration that has to deliver all this is Gabon's weak point: Public Administration is its second worst-ranked IIAG sub-category at 38.4 of 100 in 2023, 45th of 54 African states, against an overall governance score of 46.6, 32nd of 54 and below the African average of 49.3.

Regional collaboration

Gabon's digital estate reaches across its borders mainly through institutions it does not run. Its payments build sits on the CEMAC regional GIMACPAY rail, operated through GIMAC and the central bank BEAC, rather than on a national switch, a system live since July 2020 that treats cross-border transfers within the monetary union on the same basis as domestic ones. The backbone was built the same way, under the regional Central African Backbone programme, whose Gabon operation closed in 2020.

That dependence is not matched by integration more broadly. [Regional Integration](#) scored 25.4 of 100 in 2023, 46th of 54 African states, despite rising 9.7 points over the decade, and ECCAS is Gabon's only regional economic community membership.

Where Gabon has moved is on rules and enforcement rather than systems. It [ratified the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection](#) in October 2024, and it took part in Interpol's Serengeti 2.0 cybercrime operation alongside 17 other African countries in August 2025. A digital diplomacy workstream covering candidacy for International Telecommunication Union governance bodies and participation in the African Digital Ministers' Council was named a ministerial priority in July 2026.

Standards

The only interoperability framework Gabon has published governs one sector: [the CI-SIS health information interoperability framework](#), first issued in 2019 under the 2017 master plan for health information systems. Across government there is [no interoperability framework](#) setting the rules for data exchange between state systems, which means systems are still specified one at a time.

Nothing else fills the gap. Gabon has [no data quality framework](#) for government information systems, [no monitoring of their uptime](#), [no guidance for replacing legacy systems](#), and publishes nothing on interoperability compliance. The procurement lever that would enforce standards is absent too: there is [no e-procurement portal](#), so tendering and contract award are not conducted online and procurement enforces [no interoperability or technical standards](#). On software, there is [no open source policy or action plan](#) for the public sector and no body deciding on open source adoption or procurement.

The one common standard that does exist is fiscal, and it stops halfway: [a unified budget classification and chart of accounts covers central government only](#), and does not extend to sub-national government.

Of the core administrative systems Gabon does operate — financial management, tax and customs among them — none has recorded governance arrangements covering compliance, security and audit trails over its operations (2025).

Data protection

Gabon pays for its data protection regulator by the head. Under an [ordonnance of 31 January 2020](#), data controllers collect a levy of 1,000 FCFA per person per year, split 40% to the state and 60% to the authority. The regime it funds is [loi n°025/2023 of 12 July 2023](#), supervised by the [Autorité pour la Protection des Données Personnelles et de la Vie Privée](#), an independent authority covering public and private processing alike.

The law's starting position on biometrics is prohibition, not regulation: [processing biometric data is barred outright](#), the national identity card is lawful only through a derogation, and any automated processing must be declared to the APDPVP. The authority has used that machinery. [Deliberation No. 026 of 14 November 2023](#) approved the extraction of personal data from the IBOGA biometric system for the electronic identity card, and named the directorate handling access and rectification requests. It accompanied the national data centre for months before commissioning, and the operator credited it with securing the authorisations the launch required (June 2026). And on 20 January 2026 it oversaw the destruction of the personal files of unsuccessful 2022 public-tender bidders held

by the Direction générale des Marchés publics, after the retention period had run — an occasion its rapporteur used to tell public bodies to destroy sensitive documents before witnesses under the authority's supervision rather than store them loosely.

The individual's side is weaker. Access to one's own data is a free written request under Articles 43 and 44, with no online route; breach notification to the authority is mandatory and without delay; transfers to countries without adequate protection are barred, but no adequacy list has been published; and nothing is published on complaints received or on the regulator's performance. One protection is contractual rather than statutory: a covenant of the World Bank-financed identity programme requires the biometric population registry, the civil register and the identity card database to stay functionally separate. Against all of that, Digital Freedom fell 19.5 points over 2014-2023 to 38.3 of 100, 42nd of 54 African states, the fourth most deteriorated of Gabon's 96 IIAG indicators.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Deliberative and Participatory Governance is the second most deteriorated of Gabon's 96 IIAG indicators, down 22.0 points over 2014-2023 to 46.5 of 100 in 2023, 35th of 54 African states. The space for civil society has widened over the same decade — Civil Society Space rose 9.9 points to 67.8, 17th of 54 — while the Participation sub-category fell 5.2 points to 38.4: organisations can operate, but what they say does not reach the decision.

There is no digital channel for it either. Gabon has no national platform through which citizens or businesses can take part in policy decisions, submit petitions or give anonymous feedback, and no platform for lodging complaints, suggestions or information requests about service delivery, no published service standards and no demonstration that feedback is acted on. Gabon scored 0.1233 on the UN E-Participation Index in 2024, far below its overall e-government score.

None of the four public service portals the GovTech Maturity Index assesses in Gabon involves citizens in the design of its services (2025).

Speech itself is under pressure. Freedom of Expression and Belief fell 17.0 points over 2014-2023 to 60.1 of 100, and social media had been suspended for five months when the presidency defended the measure as temporary at a Libreville press conference on 17 July 2026, rejecting a political reading of it and framing it as content regulation and protection of minors. Advocacy has filled some of the vacuum: APSAD presented a report on civic and digital liberties at Libreville on 25 July 2026, built from two months of consultations with civil-society organisations, journalists, bloggers and digital-sector operators, asking the state to end blanket social-media suspensions, revise the April 2026 platform ordonnance, strengthen the Haute Autorité de la Communication's independence and open a standing dialogue with the sector. Consultation that does happen leaves little trace: when the ministry postponed the Kimba Connect final on 6 August 2026 over start-up concerns, it did not say what the objections were and no start-up was named or quoted, leaving the complaint on the record only through the body it was aimed at.

Inclusion

Digital divides

Some 1,253 villages, home to about 117,600 people or roughly 6.5% of the population, had no mobile or internet service of any kind (February 2024) — an exclusion the national averages hide, since internet and computer access is among Gabon's most improved governance indicators of the past decade and its ITU development index score places it in the upper reaches of the African ranking.

The state has written the gap it means to close into its identity programme, which sets half of personal identification number holders to be women, and rural coverage of the number to reach the national rate by 2026 from a 2020 baseline of zero (June 2024). No Gabon-specific measure of the gender gap in mobile access exists to test the first of those against: the standard cross-country survey covers twelve low and middle income countries and Gabon is not one of them (2025).

Beneath the connectivity numbers sit harder floors. Rural households reach the electricity grid at a small fraction of the urban rate (2023), and the government's own framing of the connectivity problem is geographic — forest cover means fibre cannot physically reach everywhere. Availability is also not use: the great majority of mobile connections run on 3G or better (November 2025), while no measure of smartphone ownership in Gabon is published. And the state does nothing directly to lift the skills floor, running no strategy or programme of its own to build digital skills, in the public service or for citizens and schools, and publishing no results on them (2025) — an odd omission in a country that ranks near the top of the continent for equality of access to education, and one the ministry has said only that it intends to address by strengthening its own training institutions.

Access to services

Gabon's suspension of social media was still in force five months on, with no date given for lifting it, the presidency defending the measure as temporary and conservatory at a Libreville press conference on 17 July 2026. That sits against a decade-long fall in digital freedom that ranks among Gabon's most deteriorated governance indicators (2023).

Price is not the tightest constraint on getting online: a gigabyte of mobile data cost about 4.09 US dollars in 2023, roughly 1% of monthly income per head, and residential electricity absorbs a low single-digit share of income per head at benchmark consumption (December 2025).

The documentary gate is tighter. Enrolment for the personal identification number is compulsory for every natural person present on Gabonese territory, citizens and non-nationals alike, and free of charge, and the 2022 civil registration law reaches foreign residents and even those passing through. Delivery is where it breaks: the online channel for a NIP attestation has been returning repeated rejections to applicants since the campaign opened in April 2026 (August 2026), and that falls hardest on applicants abroad, who have no counter to walk into instead. Electronic card issuance began in the capital (June 2024), and thousands of finished cards were sitting uncollected by their holders (June 2026). Public perception of how easy an identity document is to obtain has improved markedly but remains low (2023).

There is no national online portal or one-stop shop for public services, no government mobile application, and no published performance data on online delivery (2025), though sectoral tax, social insurance and pension and job portals are in use. Nor is there any platform on which a citizen can lodge a complaint or an information request about service delivery, any published service standard, or any support for users with disabilities in the channels that do exist. At the redistributive end, the register of economically weak citizens is, on the government's own diagnosis, not reliable enough to target social protection (July 2026), which is why a new census was called, even as state-backed digital payment reached everyday taxi fares (February 2026).

Technology

AI

Artificial intelligence sits in Gabon's plans and its classrooms rather than in anything running. The telecoms regulator ARCEP is leading a strategy that places artificial intelligence alongside cybersecurity and digital sovereignty in a bid to make the country a hub of digital soft power (January 2026), which is an ambition and not a deployment. In citizen engagement, no chatbot or AI-enabled discussion forum is in use (2025). The nearest thing to a domestic capability is teaching: the public Université Numérique du Gabon offers licence and master's degrees in artificial intelligence, big data and data engineering by distance learning (2025).

ICT Industry

The state has built no route by which a Gabonese technology firm can sell to it: there is no policy to support govtech start-ups or private investment in them, no government financing for innovation by small firms, no procurement rule favouring bids from start-ups or SMEs, and nothing published on start-up or SME support at all (2025). The domestic sector such policy would grow is thin, with Gabon outside the African fintech markets that draw sustained venture capital (2025), and the largest recent build was foreign-owned: the first Tier III data centre, opened at Nkok in July 2026 by a Cameroonian operator, though run by an entirely Gabonese technical staff.

Innovation ecosystem

Gabon's first national open-innovation programme was postponed within weeks of opening. Kimba Connect, launched in July 2026 to connect established firms to local start-ups so that corporate business problems become the specification for digital solutions, closed applications on 24 July 2026 with its final set for 4 August; on 6 August the Ministry of Digital Economy, Digitalisation and Innovation said it would move that date after concerns raised by participating start-ups, and gave no replacement. What the start-ups objected to has not been set out. Selected firms were promised financial accompaniment, technology support, a state-conferred quality label and facilitated market access, and on 14 July 2026 the state signed one accord against each of the two constraints it names, a guarantee mechanism with the Société Gabonaise de Garantie to share the risk banks carry in lending to young innovative firms and a skills accord with Huawei; neither has published terms.

The start-up population those instruments must grow is small and thinly capitalised. Counts of Gabonese start-ups run to roughly 150 to 200 firms (July 2026), and a commercial tracker listing about that many finds fewer than one in ten with any disclosed funding, and a single disclosed round in the year to October (2025). The UN Capital Development Fund places the country in the third tier of African fintech markets, outside those attracting sustained

venture capital (2025). Three innovation hubs and incubators — Akewa Accélérateur, the Société d'Incubation Numérique du Gabon and Ogooué Labs — operate alongside an active angel investor network (2025). Gabon is not covered by WIPO's Global Innovation Index, whose 2024 edition ranks 133 economies, so it has no innovation score.

Inside government the picture is an office without a plan. An established entity carries a public sector innovation remit, but no strategy or programme sits behind it and nothing is published on its results (2025), and there is no open source software policy or action plan for the public sector and no body that decides on adopting or procuring open source (2025) — closing off the cheapest route into a government system for a small domestic supplier.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The American thread in Gabon runs through cybersecurity. ANINF and the US-based MITRE Corporation are jointly designing the country's operational and institutional cybersecurity architecture for critical digital infrastructure (June 2026), work still at the design stage. It follows the U.S. Department of State's cybersecurity capacity-building grant of about US\$1 million to ANINF, running 2024-2025 and aimed at national cybersecurity frameworks, incident-response capability and digital resilience.

The other American strand is commercial. Gabon and Visa hold a partnership signed in May 2025, with a follow-up meeting in Libreville that July, directed at digitalising public services and modernising the state's collection of payments.

The World Bank is by some distance Gabon's principal digital financier of record, with close to US\$200 million committed across four operations; the American grant is marginal beside it (August 2026).

China activities

Huawei is Gabon's standing technical partner at both the infrastructure and the skills layers, a position consolidated by a skills accord signed on 14 July 2026 that operationalises the broader digital-transformation memorandum already in place rather than replacing it. The direction was set the year before, when Gabon opened an exploration of a strengthened technology partnership with the company in July 2025, running alongside the domestically built national data centre. Earlier again, a 2024 memorandum covering a smart-cities project and other digital services attached a large headline spending pledge to the relationship.

Everything Chinese on Gabon's record is a memorandum rather than a financing agreement, including the largest single figure in the whole picture, which is a pledge (August 2026).

EU activities

Europe's presence in Gabon is French and contractual, and it sits underneath two of the state's core registers. The electronic identity card system is run by the Interior Ministry's documentation and immigration directorate with technical support from the French supplier IN Groupe (2024), an arrangement that leaves maintenance capacity split

between government and vendor. It rests on a long commercial footing: IN Groupe (Imprimerie Nationale) [signed a five-year partnership with the directorate in November 2015](#), covering maintenance of the secure-title issuance platform it had delivered to the state and an extension of the main secure-titles supply contract.

On the land side, the Ministry of Housing [has engaged the French firm IGN FI to modernise the cadastre](#) towards an integrated urban land management system (2025).

India activities

No Indian party had a role in Gabon's digital infrastructure, platforms, financing or skills programmes as at August 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf party had a role in Gabon's digital infrastructure, platforms, financing or skills programmes as at August 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Gabon ranks 2nd of 54 African states on [equality in education](#), scoring 76.6 of 100 (2023), and 35th on whether pupils actually finish: its [education completion score is 28.0 of 100](#) (2023), up 4.1 points over 2014-2023. Access is distributed unusually evenly by African standards, and what is being distributed evenly is a school system most children leave without completing.

The aggregate follows the completion figure rather than the equality one. [Education is Gabon's second worst-ranked governance sub-category](#), at 42.7 of 100 in 2023 and 40th of 54, and it has moved 1.0 point in a decade — close to flat while the equality score slipped 0.5.

Two of the six education indicators cannot be scored at all: Gabon has [no score for education enrolment or for human resources in education](#) (2023), because the underlying figures are not reported to UNESCO. How many children are in school, and how many teachers stand in front of them, are therefore not answerable from the international record — which is a statement about the education ministry's reporting as much as about its schools. Work on the underlying collection has been running since March 2025, with [tablets and data-collection software distributed to schools](#) to feed the education management information system, and [UNICEF and Airtel Gabon have equipped some rural schools with tablets and connectivity](#) (2026) for learning content.

On digital literacy specifically, the state adds nothing to what the schools do: no digital skills programme is [freely available to citizens or to schools](#), and no results on digital skills are published (2025).

Training and skills

Gabon has [no government strategy or programme for digital skills in the public service](#), no freely available programme for citizens or schools, and publishes no results (2025). The training that exists is therefore supplied by vendors, donors and universities rather than directed by the state, and the most consequential of those arrangements is the newest.

On 14 July 2026 Gabon signed a [skills accord with Huawei Technologies Gabon](#), giving the company a technical accompaniment role for the Kimba Connect start-up programme: "salles intelligentes" for innovation, training in networks, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and software development, and access to Huawei's own certifying training kits. Curriculum, certificate and equipment come from one foreign supplier, and the accord's [terms have not been published](#) — no room count, trainee target, cost or duration (July 2026).

The domestic pipeline is thin but real. The [Universite Numerique du Gabon](#), a public distance-learning institution, offers licence and master's degrees in computer science, cybersecurity, big data, artificial intelligence, DevOps and data engineering (2025), and the [Universite des Sciences et Techniques de Masuku](#) trains computer and telecommunications engineers from technician to doctoral level. A 2025 workshop worked to [embed UNESCO Global Skills Academy digital skills certifications into university curricula](#), alongside the UNESCO China Funds-in-Trust programme for higher education. What happens to the graduates is harder to see: the state's only visible instrument on that side is a [government job portal offering registration and search](#) (2025).

Training also happens as a condition of using government systems. DGDI closed a series of [e-Visa familiarisation sessions for the tourism trade](#) — tour-operator federations, guides, agencies, hotels, restaurants — in Libreville on 31 July 2026, and the [second national Cybersecurity Forum](#) met in November 2025 on critical infrastructure. The [three identified innovation hubs](#) carry much of what founders learn (2025).

Research institutions

Gabon's research base in computing and engineering rests on a single institution. The [Université des Sciences et Techniques de Masuku](#), founded in 1986 and incorporating the former École Polytechnique de Masuku, takes science and engineering qualifications — computer and telecommunications engineering among them — up to doctoral level (2025), and it is the one body producing research-trained engineers rather than only teaching users of other people's systems.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Gabon has [no score at all for the Rural Economy sub-category of the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance](#), nor for any of its four indicators — rural land and water access, rural market access, rural economy support, and rural representation and participation — because the IFAD data the measures draw on are unavailable for the country (2023). The rural economy is, for measurement purposes, uncounted.

At the point of service the picture is consistent. Rural primary healthcare clinics [record patient data on paper](#), pushed to paper registers by unreliable connectivity and few computers (2022). Police stations and gendarmerie brigades keep criminal cases, complaints and custody records [on paper too](#), with digitalisation of custody records discussed as a future ambition and infrastructure limits flagged as a particular constraint in remote areas (February 2026). Civil registration is [paper-based and decentralised at the point of registration](#), with a centralised digital registry positioned as a future state of the IBOGA identity project (2023). Schools are the exception in motion: the Ministry of National Education has been [distributing tablets and data-collection software](#) with the World Bank and UNESCO since March 2025 to strengthen the education management information system.

The constraints under all of this are physical. Rural electricity access remains far below the [near-universal urban rate](#) (2023), a set of villages still has [no mobile or internet coverage at all](#) (February 2024), and the forest cover across most of the country means [fibre cannot reach everywhere](#) (July 2026). The second phase of the [universal electronic communications service programme](#), run with Airtel Gabon and Moov Africa Gabon Telecom and funded by a sector levy, was identifying sites and deploying radio stations across all nine provinces through 2025, and the digital identity programme carries an [explicit rural coverage target](#) alongside its gender one (June 2024).

Digitalisation of sub-national government

ANINF [opened its first provincial office, in Franceville in Haut-Ogooué](#), in June 2026 — the agency's first presence anywhere outside the capital since 2011.

Below that, the machinery of the digital state stops at the centre. [No regional or local government body exchanges data on any platform](#), and the inter-ministerial committee coordinating digital public administration under the Prime Minister's office, created in February 2021 with ANINF as coordinator, sits above a layer that does not participate (2024). The [integrated financial management system in use](#) is limited in scope to central government and in function to treasury execution (2025), and the unified budget classification and chart of accounts [likewise cover central government only](#) (2025) — so local accounts have no shared basis on which to consolidate with national ones.

The movement in the other direction is at the capital: the municipality of Libreville [committed in July 2026 to supporting the deployment of MADIGIPAIE](#), putting the capital's local government behind the national digital-payments programme.

Data

National statistics

Gabon has [run no agricultural survey and no business survey in ten years, and only one household survey and one labour survey in that period, against two health surveys](#) (2023). The censuses have been done — [agricultural, business and population, each within the same ten-year window](#) — so the state takes a full count roughly once a decade and then goes years without the intermediate measurement that would tell it what has changed since.

The same pattern shows in the pillar scores, where [data use and data products sit in the 50-69% band while statistical services, data sources and statistical infrastructure all sit in the weaker 20-49% band](#) (2023): Gabon does more with what it has than it does to generate it. The direction is upward. The [capacity of its statistical system scored](#)

39.4 of 100 in 2023, 37th of 54 African states, a gain of 12.0 points over the decade and one of the country's ten most improved governance indicators — a decade that also held a World Bank statistical development project financing national accounts, welfare monitoring and agricultural statistics, a dissemination platform and institutional reform, which closed in 2023.

The gaps are visible wherever an index has nothing to score: education enrolment and human resources in education carry no IIAG value at all, and neither does the entire rural economy sub-category. Administrative systems are not filling the space. The state's financial management system records no expenditure linked to the Sustainable Development Goals and carries no non-financial performance indicators for government programmes (2025), so budget data cannot answer what the spending achieved; health reporting only went national on DHIS2 in December 2024, fed by staff transcribing paper registers. The government's own diagnosis is that its register of economically weak citizens cannot reliably target social protection, and a second census of that population is to begin fieldwork in September 2026.

Open data

Gabon has no open data portal publishing government datasets for reuse (2025), and disclosure of public records is one of its ten worst governance indicators, at 11.7 of 100 in 2023, 49th of 54 African states and barely moved across the decade. Access is the better half of the picture and the improving one — accessibility of public records reached 21.2 of 100 in 2023, up 7.7 points over 2014-2023 — but from a level that leaves most of what the state holds out of reach in practice.

What is published is uneven by domain. Government finance is the strongest category in Open Data Watch's 2024 inventory at 6 out of 10, with national accounts, trade, labour, prices, poverty, population, education and health facilities between 3 and 5, and energy at 2.5. Four categories score zero — digital economy, built environment, pollution and food security (2024), meaning nothing meeting the coverage and openness tests is published in them at all.

Of the sixteen transparency tests the GovTech Maturity Index applies, Gabon fails fourteen (2025): nothing is published on cloud usage, interoperability compliance, public investment projects, digital skills results, data governance, data protection complaints, regulator performance, online service delivery, right-to-information implementation, public sector innovation, startup support, government responses to citizens or public service standards. On the two it passes — digital transformation progress and GovTech institutional performance — reports are produced and kept internal.

There is no general right to ask for what is not published: Gabon has no right-to-information law, no body monitoring any such right, and no figures on requests received or granted (2025). The one enforceable claim on government-held data is personal, and only over one's own file — the 2023 data protection law gives an individual confirmation of and a copy of data held about them, on free written request rather than through any online service. Nor is anyone in the state answerable for the question: there is no dedicated entity for data governance, no data governance strategy or policy, and nothing published on how government data is governed (2025).

Use of satellite data

Gabon's satellite ambitions run to communications rather than observation, and no Earth observation programme or geospatial data policy was in place as at August 2026: the country [opened a national policy process on satellite communications at a Libreville seminar in July 2026](#), framed as digital sovereignty and due to produce a strategic recommendations document for government. The case put there was geographic, resting on [forest cover that fibre cannot reach past](#).

Finance

New investments

Seven per cent of the roughly [44 billion CFA francs of World Bank financing behind the eGabon and Gabon Digital programmes had been disbursed by the fifth steering committee in February 2026](#), with ministers recording that the foundations were in place but execution too slow.

The largest live commitment is the [Digital Gabon Project](#), about US\$68 million of IBRD lending approved in July 2021 and running to 2028 for connectivity, digital government services, digital financial infrastructure and the ICT sector. Its appraised design puts [US\\$24.5 million into modernising legal identity systems – the flagship component – US\\$20 million into the enabling environment, US\\$17 million into public administration and services and US\\$7 million into citizen engagement](#). [eGabon](#) adds about US\$56 million, approved in June 2016 and ending in 2026, financing e-government infrastructure, a government data centre and the digitalisation of administrative procedures. Two older loans have closed: [US\\$50 million for statistical system modernisation](#), approved in 2017 and closed in 2023, and [about US\\$23 million of additional financing for the Central African Backbone build](#), closed in 2020.

The rest is small, or is not money into the country. [MIGA](#) issued about US\$28 million of political-risk cover in 2022 over a private-equity stake in Airtel Mobile Commerce's Gabonese subsidiary, insuring the Airtel Money wallet business against war, expropriation and inconvertibility. The [U.S. Department of State](#) is funding about US\$1 million of cybersecurity capacity-building with ANINF over 2024-2025, and the [ITU](#) ran a CHF 1.24 million regional project between 2021 and 2023 on ICT indicators with CEMAC regulators and statistics offices, Gabon among eight target countries.

Eight commitments and pledges are on the record, made between 2016 and 2024 by six financiers. Around US\$227 million of that is finance actually committed, and about US\$197 million of it is four IBRD loans – non-concessional sovereign borrowing, with grant money amounting to a single small award. Three commitments worth roughly US\$125 million were still live as at August 2026. Connectivity and e-government take most of the recorded total, and the largest figure of all is a private pledge under a memorandum rather than a financing agreement.

MoUs and other agreements

Gabon signed an [accord with the Société Gabonaise de Garantie on 14 July 2026](#) to establish guarantee mechanisms that would cut the risk banks bear in lending to young innovative firms, its director-general Alban Etho putting risk-sharing as the condition for improving start-up access to bank credit. It has no published guarantee ceiling, coverage

ratio, eligibility test, term or participating banks, and the [skills accord signed with Huawei Technologies Gabon the same day](#) — smart classrooms, training in networks, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and software development, and access to the company's certifying training kits — has no room count, trainee target, cost or duration.

That is the pattern across the rest. Gabon signed a [memorandum of understanding with Huawei in 2024](#) for a smart-cities project and other digital services, carrying a pledge of spending rather than a financing agreement, and the July 2026 skills accord operationalises a [broader memorandum agreed in late 2025 on national digital transformation and a Connected Schools expansion](#), leaving one vendor as the standing technical partner at both the infrastructure and the skills layer. ANINF and ST Digital signed a [framework agreement in July 2025](#) covering secure digital infrastructure, cloud, cybersecurity, digital identity and e-government with local capacity-building; no value, delivery date or committed scope of work attaches to it, which makes it a statement of intent. A [partnership with Visa](#), agreed in May 2025 and followed up in Libreville on 18 July 2025, is directed at digitalising public services and modernising how the state collects payments, again with no value attached.

The exception is with a development agency rather than a vendor: Gabon signed an [agreement with the UN Capital Development Fund in December 2025](#) to accelerate financial inclusion, tying digital identity to access to financial services.

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